Code of Conduct

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Owner: Ethics and Compliance Office, Acme Analytics Pvt Ltd

Note: Fictional sample document created for testing a RAG system. Acme Analytics Pvt Ltd is not a real company.

1. Our values

1.1 The Code of Conduct describes how every employee, intern and consultant of Acme Analytics Pvt Ltd is expected to behave. It applies in the office, at client sites, while working remotely, at company events and on social media.

1.2 Our four values are Integrity, Respect, Ownership and Customer Focus. When a situation is not covered by the Code, use these values to decide, and ask your manager or the Ethics Office if you are unsure.

2. Respect at the workplace

2.1 Treat colleagues, clients and vendors with dignity. Discrimination or harassment based on gender, religion, caste, region, language, disability, age, sexual orientation or marital status is not tolerated.

2.2 Sexual harassment is dealt with under the POSH Policy, which sets up an Internal Committee and a separate complaint process.

2.3 Bullying, shouting, offensive jokes, and abusive messages on chat, email or social media are violations of the Code.

3. Conflict of interest

3.1 A conflict of interest arises when a personal interest could influence, or appear to influence, a business decision. Examples include a family member working for a vendor or a competitor, or an employee holding more than 2% of the shares of a supplier.

3.2 An employee must disclose a possible conflict of interest in writing to the manager and the Ethics Office within 7 days of becoming aware of it.

3.3 Employees must not take part in any hiring, buying or contract decision in which they have a conflict.

4. Gifts and hospitality

4.1 Employees must not accept or offer gifts, favours or entertainment that could influence a business decision.

4.2 The treatment of a gift depends on its value, as shown in the table below.

Value of a single gift (Indian rupees)	What you must do
Up to Rs 1,000	May be accepted; no declaration needed
Rs 1,001 to Rs 3,000	May be accepted; declare it to the Ethics Office within 7 days
Above Rs 3,000	Must be politely declined or returned; if that is not possible, hand it to the Ethics Office

Value of a single gift (Indian rupees)	What you must do
Cash or gift cards (any value)	Never accepted

4.3 Festival gifts such as sweets and dry fruits sent to the whole team may be shared with the team.

5. Anti-bribery and corruption

Acme has a zero-tolerance approach to bribery. No employee may offer, pay, ask for or accept a bribe, a kickback or a facilitation payment, directly or through a third party, to anyone including government officials. Political donations in the name of the company are prohibited.

6. Confidentiality and data privacy

6.1 Employees must keep confidential all non-public information about Acme, its clients, its employees and its products. This duty continues after leaving the company.

6.2 Personal data of customers and employees may be used only for the purpose for which it was collected. Any suspected data breach must be reported to the security team immediately, as described in the IT Security and Acceptable Use Policy.

6.3 Employees must not share client names, project details or internal numbers on social media or in public forums.

7. Outside work and moonlighting

7.1 Employees must not take up any other paid employment, consulting assignment or business that competes with Acme or affects their work, without the prior written approval of the Human Resources head. Taking up such work without approval is called moonlighting and is a violation of this Code.

7.2 Unpaid voluntary work, teaching on weekends and writing books or blogs are permitted if they do not use company time, resources or confidential information, and do not create a conflict of interest.

8. Dress code and workplace behaviour

8.1 The dress code is business casual in the office. Business formal is expected for client meetings, unless the client says otherwise.

8.2 Consumption of alcohol, tobacco or illegal substances on company premises or during work hours is not allowed. Company events where alcohol is served must be approved by the Human Resources head, and employees must drink responsibly and not drive after drinking.

8.3 Employees must not carry weapons on company premises.

9. Use of company assets

Company laptops, software, email and networks are for business use. Limited personal use is allowed if it does not breach the IT Security and Acceptable Use Policy. Employees are responsible for the safe keeping of assets issued to them.

10. Raising concerns and the Ethics Helpline

10.1 Employees who see or suspect a violation of this Code should report it to their manager, to Human Resources, or to the Ethics Helpline.

10.2 The Ethics Helpline is run by an independent agency, is open 24 hours a day, and allows anonymous reports. Contact details: email ethics@acme-analytics.example, phone 1800-000-1234.

10.3 Acme protects anyone who reports a concern in good faith. Retaliation against such an employee is itself a serious violation of the Code.

11. Investigation and disciplinary action

11.1 Every report is acknowledged within 3 working days. The Ethics Committee aims to complete its investigation within 45 days.

11.2 Depending on how serious the violation is, the actions are: a verbal warning, a written warning, suspension, withholding of an increment or promotion, and termination of employment.

11.3 Termination without notice pay may follow gross misconduct, such as fraud, theft, falsification of records, harassment, violence, or a serious breach of confidentiality.

11.4 An employee under investigation has the right to be heard and to give a written explanation before any decision is taken.